

09. COUPONS, PROMOTIONAL DISCOUNTS & REDEMPTION RULES

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OWNER: Store Policy & Operations Governance	CLASSIFICATION: Authoritative Public Policy	GROUNDING: Strict RAG Retrieval

1. Promotional Coupons & Discount Rules

Promotional codes allow customers to enjoy percentage discounts, fixed rupee markdowns, or complimentary shipping. The following strict governance rules apply:

- Single Coupon Stacking Rule: Only ONE promotional coupon code may be applied per checkout order. Coupons cannot be stacked or combined.
- Minimum Order Requirement: Certain coupon codes require a minimum qualifying cart value before the discount activates.
- Maximum Discount Cap: Percentage-based coupons may have an upper monetary discount ceiling.
- First-Order Exclusive Codes: Introductory discounts are restricted strictly to first-time customer accounts with no prior order history.
- Exclusions: Coupons do not apply to gift cards, charity merchandise, or products explicitly tagged 'Final Sale'.

2. Troubleshooting Coupon Errors

Error Message Displayed	Underlying Cause	Resolution Action
Coupon code expired	Promotional validity date has passed	Check newsletter for current active promotional codes
Cart minimum not met	Subtotal is below qualifying threshold	Add items to reach minimum eligible cart value
Usage limit exceeded	Code has reached maximum lifetime redemptions	Code is exhausted; use an alternate active promotion
Already used by account	Single-use promo code previously redeemed	Code can only be redeemed once per customer account

DATABASE VERIFICATION: Coupon calculations are strictly validated on the Spring Boot backend server. The AI Chatbot does not generate or validate coupon codes independently.

KNOWLEDGE BASE NOTICE & RETRIEVAL BOUNDARIES: This document is an authoritative policy reference intended for grounding our store AI/RAG assistant. Store policies, shipping charges, return periods, and operational terms are governed by active store settings. Dynamic customer data—including live product prices, real-time variant inventory, order shipment tracking, user profile addresses, and coupon code validity—must ALWAYS be resolved via live PostgreSQL application database APIs rather than static document text. If information is not covered within this knowledge base, the chatbot must clearly state that the information is unavailable and offer customer support assistance.